criticisms from many quarters, including the Americans themselves. The truth was that the massive effort did not result in any visible success, especially after the Tet offensive of North Vietnam and the Viet Cong in 1968. Therefore, the United States wanted to end the Vietnam War in an honourable way and thought that Soviet help was necessary as the Soviets were also actively involved in the war and provided economic and military assistance to North Vietnam. Disengagement from Vietnam became the prime motivation for Nixon and Kissinger to seek détente.

Soviet Compulsions: The change in the attitude of the policy makers in Kremlin also became a factor for Moscow to seek détente. Malenkov, who became the Russian Prime Minister after Stalin's death, had started his drive towards détente but it became more evident in Khrushchev and later in Brezhnev–Kosygin period. They embarked upon a policy of peaceful coexistence. Besides, there were also economic compulsions on the part of the Soviet Union. The lopsided development created shortage of wage-goods and other consumer durables as a result unemployment was on the rise. As Northedge and Grieve observed, "Again the rising living standards in the Soviet Union probably gave that country a strong interest, like Americans'; in reducing the massive scale of arms expenditure in the cold war by arms control agreements, in increasing its lagging technology by agreements with the Western powers to make their skills and equipment available to Russian industry and perhaps above all, in keeping *status quo* stable in eastern Europe, when it was threatened by liberalization programme of Dubchek of Czechoslovakia".[14]

The China Factor: The emergence of China as another major power led not only to easing of tensions between the two superpowers but also ushered in the Sino–American rapproachement. The rise of Communist China posed a direct challenge to the Soviet Union as China became the alternative source of aid and encouragement to the liberation movements in South-East Asia and even communist states in Eastern Europe, such as Albania and Rumania. Further, in 1964 China detonated its first atomic bomb. What became evident was the growing Sino–